

DLAI 2025/2026 Project Guidelines

This a.y., the exam will be held **exclusively in BYOP format (Bring Your Own Project)**.

Please read and follow these guidelines thoroughly.

1. Topics

Students **do not need to email the professor to communicate the topic** of their project.

Likewise, **prior approval is not required**, provided that the project clearly falls within one or more of the following areas:

<i>training dynamics</i>	<i>model merging</i>
<i>multitask learning</i>	<i>artificial life</i>
<i>optimization for deep learning</i>	<i>gaming and AI</i>
<i>deep learning theory</i>	<i>distributed learning</i>
<i>representation learning</i>	<i>program synthesis</i>
<i>multimodal learning</i>	<i>quantization</i>
<i>language models</i>	<i>image/video generation</i>
<i>deep learning for audio</i>	<i>reasoning</i>

If a project fits cleanly within these areas, students may proceed without requesting permission.

Projects are **not allowed** if they fall outside these areas or move primarily toward the following application domains:

<i>robotics</i>	<i>biomedical applications</i>
<i>time series forecasting</i>	<i>graph learning</i>
<i>Gaussian splatting</i>	<i>neural rendering</i>
<i>finance</i>	<i>sports</i>
<i>education</i>	<i>non-AI or non-ML topics</i>

In borderline cases, students should contact the professor for clarification.

2. Deliverables

The required deliverables for the project are:

- a link to the project repository
 - the repository may be public or private
 - if private, it must be shared with the professor and the teaching assistants
- a **2-page report** prepared according to the fixed template available on the course page
- a **statement describing the use of AI tools in the development of the project**

The AI-use statement is **mandatory**. It is a new requirement this year, and it is not included in the 2-page limit. Its length may be as long as necessary. Students should refer to the instructions provided in the report template.

Reports that do not comply with the official template will be graded only up to the length corresponding to the official template. Any material beyond the maximum permitted length will be ignored.

3. Delivery method

Send all the material required in the previous section at the following email addresses, using the “[DLAI 2026] Project delivery” subject line: {rodola,strano,solombrino}@di.uniroma1.it

Sending your project to other email addresses might interfere with the grading process, so please do **NOT** use different addresses from the provided ones.

4. Individual and group projects

The default format is a **single-student project**.

Group projects are also allowed, and **no prior permission is needed**. However, a larger team is expected to produce a correspondingly larger project. Perceived match between project scale and team size will be one of the grading criteria.

To account for this, the maximum report length (excluding AI statement, references and appendix) increases by **one page for each additional team member**. For example:

- 1 student → 2 pages
- 2 students → 3 pages
- 3 students → 4 pages

and so on.

5. Grading timeline

Projects will be graded **only close to the official exam date** for the selected session. Students should therefore **not request early grading**.

A project will be graded **only if the student is registered on Infostud** for the chosen exam session.